

MADHURIMA

A Textbook of Arts
for Grade 9



0914

विद्यया ऽ मृतमश्नुते



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NCERT

राष्ट्रीय शैक्षिक अनुसंधान और प्रशिक्षण परिषद्
NATIONAL COUNCIL OF EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH AND TRAINING

0914 – MADHURIMA

A Textbook of Arts for Grade 9

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Foreword

The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 envisions an education system that is firmly rooted in India's civilisational wisdom, values, and ethical traditions. The rich intellectual heritage simultaneously enables learners to engage meaningfully with the complexities and possibilities of a rapidly changing world. The National Curriculum Framework for School Education (NCF-SE) 2023 provides concrete expression to this vision by laying out a coherent curricular pathway across stages of schooling that nurtures critical thinking, creativity, and sensitivity, along with the values and dispositions that are needed for responsible citizenship in an interconnected global society.

Learners have progressed through the Foundational, Preparatory, and Middle Stages, where their inherent potential has been nurtured holistically. Now, they enter the Secondary Stage with enhanced capacity for reflection, reasoning, enquiry, and self-expression. Spanning across Grades 9 to 10, also known as the adolescent stage, it marks a crucial period in the intellectual and personal growth of the students. It prepares them to engage with abstract ideas, complex social realities, ethical dilemmas, and the expanding universe of knowledge, while deepening their understanding of the self and the world around them.

A diverse curriculum, covering 10 subjects: three languages—including at least two languages native to India—Science, Mathematics, Social Sciences, Art Education, Physical Education and Well-being, Individuals in Society/Environmental Education, and Vocational Education, has to be studied and experienced to promote holistic development. NEP 2020 suggests “no hard separations between arts and sciences, between curricular and extra-curricular activities”, between vocational and academic streams, etc., in order to eliminate harmful hierarchies among, and silos between different areas of learning; a rootedness and pride in India, and its rich, diverse, ancient and modern culture, and knowledge systems and traditions. NCF-SE 2023 further recommends, “The Arts strongly rely on perceptual knowledge”, which is about experiencing the world through all the senses of our body. The Arts also connect emotions and sensory experiences. Procedural knowledge in the Arts is largely associated with the process of making or creating artwork. *Madhurima*, a textbook of Arts for Grade 9, has been conceptualised and developed with the above prerogatives.

A spectrum of genres has been covered in *Madhurima* that reflects the socio-cultural and geographical landscapes through which students are sure to contextualise their lived experiences in different forms of Art. The content has

been selected to engage learners with the elements and interrelationship of all art forms— Theatre, Music, Dance, and Visual Arts. It has also addressed needs of the vibrant, young minds which embrace technology, aspirations, and human relationships. This will further encourage learners to think critically about the world they inhabit. The textbook draws upon India’s artistic, literary, and intellectual traditions, weaving into it elements of Indian Knowledge Systems and our cultural heritage, seamlessly connecting them with our contemporary experiences.

While *Madhurima* is an important resource to learn about traditions in art forms, it also invites students to engage with a broader world of contemporary arts and community knowledge. The role of teachers and parents is, therefore, pivotal in nurturing a rich culture and independent exploration at this stage. The textbook integrates technology through the use of QR codes in each unit, to provide additional resources in Arts.

The National Council of Educational Research and Training acknowledges with deep appreciation the contributions of the Textbook Development Team, subject experts, pedagogues, practising teachers, reviewers, and all others who have supported the development of this textbook. We hope that *Madhurima* will inspire learners to think deeply, communicate confidently, and participate thoughtfully in the intellectual and social life of our nation and the world. We also warmly welcome suggestions and feedback from all its users for further improvement in the subsequent editions.

New Delhi
March 2026

DINESH PRASAD SAKLANI
Director
National Council of Educational
Research and Training

About the Book

We began this journey to understand the many expressions of Art in our country from Grade 3. You may have noticed that India is a unique example of *anektā meṇ ekatā*—Unity in Diversity. The diversity of this land comes naturally from its different landscapes, people, and ways of living, and it is beautifully reflected in their artistic expressions. Across the country, we experience a variety of art forms filled with different emotions, ideas, and styles. Yet, when we look closely, we can find a common thread that connects them all—a shared spirit. You may have already felt this connection while exploring the Art textbooks so far. The focus of this series of textbooks for every grade is *Bharat Bodh* (Awareness of India).

The National Curriculum Framework for School Education 2023 (NCF-SE 2023) lays emphasis on a paradigm shift of learning by acquiring competencies such as application to real-life situations, logical thinking, experimentation, observation and analysis, teamwork, inclusivity, etc. *Madhurima*, a textbook of Arts for Grade 9, is designed to pave our way forward, enabling us to embark on multiple in-depth approaches. The roadmap aims to strengthen the linkages between education and culture. By now, the idea must have internalised that the Arts are deeply embedded in our everyday life and, because of their variety, remain the most flexible form of expression where multiple interpretations are possible and valid. It provides a creative pathway that enables students to enhance their analytical, descriptive, and narrative capabilities rooted in aesthetics. It also prepares them for the challenges and opportunities that await them in the twenty-first century.

This textbook envisions inclusive classrooms where every child, including those with disabilities, actively participates in all activities. The content has been designed with the flexibility to be adapted and accommodated to suit the diverse needs and capacities of all learners. Teachers are encouraged to make the necessary modifications so that no child is left out of the learning experience.

Madhurima, a textbook of Arts, aims to showcase an array of artistic expressions across four forms of Art—Theatre, Music, Dance, and Visual Arts—as in the previous years. All sections in this textbook aspire to give each individual sustained engagement with diverse art forms. It aims to enable learners to appreciate the commonalities, interconnectedness, and diversity of aesthetic sensibilities. The present textbook showcases different contexts and perspectives of the *navarasa*, their application processes, and the delightful outcomes across all art forms—both tangible and intangible across Indian and global art practices. Inclusivity of all genders and students with special abilities is inherent in the Arts, ensuring equal opportunity for all learners.

Such a transformative learning culture requires appropriate and interactive textbooks, which will play a central role in mediating between content and pedagogy—a role that strikes a judicious balance between direct instruction within and across curricular areas. Hence, *Madhurima* has infused content in every form that requires ample experiential sessions, exposure to artistic works of stalwarts, and multiple genres of expression. The activities in the textbook may be modified to suit the local context and the specific needs of all learners. Making optimum use of technology integration, QR codes have also been embedded throughout as additional learning resources. Thus, this textbook invites all students to read, enjoy, experience, and progress towards developing a world of aesthetics and meaningful growth.

The textbook comprises 17 chapters in all. The first chapter is an interdisciplinary one, encompassing all art forms, whereas the four sections represent the four different art forms — Theatre, Music, Dance, and Visual Arts. Chapter 1 as well as the first chapter of each of the sections are compulsory for all students having Learning Standards 1 and 2. All art forms include both practical and theoretical components. This year, another common aspect in the textbook is the idea of creating journals in different art forms, which is a unique process of documenting and recording personal experiences. The other elements in different sections are as follows:

The first chapter of the textbook introduces historical development of all art forms. Glimpses of the period from 50,000 BCE to 1200 CE are given to inspire learners to understand how people across different parts of the world evolved different art forms simultaneously. While the underlying spirit remained similar, the varied expressions, diverse themes, thought processes, and expressions reflect compelling stories of the richness of human creativity.

Theatre

This art form has given ideas of storytelling, teamwork for performances, and communication. Learners will explore its scope through body language, expression, voice, improvisation, story building, and the creation of drama. The content includes the *navarasa* from the *Nāṭyaśāstra* and its application even in contemporary spaces. Puppetry, costume, make-up, backstage tasks, mime, script and genres, logo design, symbolic representation, stage lighting, etc., are some of the titles in theatre.

Music

Music education includes singing diverse compositions across classical, folk, regional, and contemporary genres to help students experience India's rich musical traditions of India. An effort has been made to acquaint students with

traditional communities practising folk arts, fostering a sense of inclusivity, reducing gender biases, and enhancing understanding of how the Arts have woven the rich tapestry of the Indian Knowledge System. Students will explore *rāgas*, rhythm patterns, and instruments rooted in the *Vedas*, study the historical evolution of music and its *granthas*, and understand how Indian music gained global recognition through renowned musicians.

Along with this, acquiring basic skills in singing and playing musical instruments—including nuances of both Hindustani and Carnatic Music for the rendition of *rāgas* and presentation methods—is also a curricular focus. The textbook thoughtfully integrates interdisciplinary perspectives, highlighting the intrinsic connections between music and the sciences, social sciences, and languages. While stories of some inspiring musicians are included, students are encouraged to create their own music, document their experiences in a journal, and maintain records of their learning. A section is also devoted to encouraging students to reflect on how to continue making music a part of their lives, including its role in well-being and healthcare.

Dance

The section on Dance introduces concepts related to posture and the lines of the dancing body. While the feet maintain rhythm, the face and hands convey the nine fundamental human emotions (*navarasa*) to the audience. Corresponding to this concept, the art of *abhinaya*, a form of expressive communication across various genres of dance, has been described vividly. Choreography is another concept which has been discussed, including stylised body movements, synchronisation, exploration of formations, spacing, etc., which form an amalgamation of both regional and classical styles. Cultural connections through dance—such as the global presence of Indian dance forms as well as the *Rāmāyaṇa* linking India and Southeast Asia—are highlighted as an interesting feature of this section. It will be an eye-opener for learners and will help enhance their understanding of how our art forms have travelled to distant places and captivated global audiences.

Visual Arts

The chapters on Visual Arts emphasise on guiding students in applying the fundamentals as they discover the elements and principles of art and design in everyday life and surroundings. They will also expand their knowledge of materials, mediums, and techniques, and learn to create their own compositions in a systematic and iterative manner. Invite local artists and craftspeople to conduct interactive sessions and workshops that offer students hands-on experiences. Emphasise routines such as cleaning up after work (for example,

putting back art materials that students use and maintaining them with care). Encourage students to participate in decision-making related to the selection of artwork for classroom display or exhibitions.

In all the sections, there is an introduction to the section, followed by a general note for the teachers regarding the discipline-specific pedagogy — how to take the subject forward, organise activities, give projects and assignments, etc. This section also provides the Curricular Goals of each chapter and addresses how to write a journal or document, incorporating individual experiences and expressions.

Each of the chapters have some common pedagogical features to support the process.

Note to the Teacher

Important points which prompt for curricular transaction by the teacher



Note to the teacher: Keep a few videos of two different traditions of dance, music, or theatre performances ready to play in class.

Let Us Recall

Recall content given in the previous textbooks and make connections with new knowledge

Let us recall

You have read about the *stūpa* at Sanchi in Chapter 5 of the Grade 7 Social Science textbook *Exploring Society: India and Beyond*.

Discussion Circle

Encourages dialogue, peer interaction, and exchange of ideas to deepen understanding

Discussion circle

- ◇ Why do you think ancient scholars composed treatises that codified the arts?
- ◇ On what basis do you think they devised theories, and do you think they remained constant over time?

Let Us Explore

Prompts students to investigate new concepts, situations, or examples through guided inquiry or observation

Let us explore

Which category of instruments do you think the harp belongs to? What role might this instrument have played in Egyptian culture?

Activity

Different types of activities to experience concepts

Activity 1.3

Watch performances and make notes in your journal

Watch short videos of two different performances of Indian dance, music, or theatre.



Do You Know?

Interesting facts or connections linked to the concept of the section which extends beyond the core learning

Do you know?

Kauṭilya's *Arthaśāstra* recognises *naṭa*, *nartakī*, *gāyaka/vādaka* as professional performers who contribute towards the state's economy.

Exercises

Questions related to the content at the end of each chapter

Project Work

Project work encompassing all themes/ topics addressed in the section will come at the end of each section.

Assessment

All the activities given in the textbook are meant to be assessed by the teacher. However, all the śloka, diacritical marks on Indian language words, and 'Do you know' boxes are meant for classroom practices only and will not be assessed.

It would be enriching for learners to practise and experience all the art forms according to the suggestion given. Try to find innovative ways to experience them in a unique manner.

SHARBARI BANERJEE

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A Note on the Pronunciation of Indian Language Words

Since this textbook is in English, we use the Roman alphabet. But we will also encounter some words in Sanskrit and other Indian languages. The Roman alphabet cannot make its pronunciation clear without some additional marks or signs, such as dashes, dots or accents, called ‘diacritical marks’ or simply ‘diacritics’. You can ignore all these marks if you wish, as their standard spelling and their spelling with diacritics will generally be the same. However, as we are using only a few simple marks, it will help you pronounce such words accurately. You will also find that they help you pronounce Sanskrit and other Indian language words correctly.

For those who wish to know the precise representation of the Devanāgarī alphabet in the Roman script in our system, the tables of letters are as follows:

Transliteration Tables

Common Indian Language Alphabet – Devanāgarī to Roman script

Vowels	अ	a	आ	ā	इ	i	ई	ī	उ	u	ऊ	ū
	ऋ	ṛi	ॠ	ṛī	ए	e	ऐ	ai	ओ	o	औ	au

Consonants	क	ka	ख	kha	ग	ga	घ	gha	ङ	ṅa
	च	cha	छ	chha	ज	ja	झ	jha	ञ	ña
	ट	ṭa	ठ	ṭha	ड	ḍa	ढ	ḍha	ण	ṇa
	त	ta	थ	tha	द	da	ध	dha	न	na
	प	pa	फ	pha	ब	ba	भ	bha	म	ma
	य	ya	र	ra	ल	la	व	va		
	श	śha	ष	ṣha	स	sa	ह	ha	ळ	ḷa
	अं	aṁ	अः	aḥ						

Conjunct Consonants

Such consonants are formed by joining two consonants. They are listed below.

क्ष	kṣha	त्र	tra	ज्ञ	jña	श्र	śhra	र्ण	rṇa	न्ध	ndhya	च्छ	chchha
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Madhurima, a textbook of Arts, contains words from various Indian languages, but not all are written with diacritics. There are a few exceptions to this:

- Indian language words with sounds that cannot be represented by the diacritical marks, as in the table above;
- Names of people who have signed their names in English;
- Names of places;
- Names of commonly known instruments; and
- Names of commonly known art forms.

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THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

PREAMBLE

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA, having solemnly resolved to constitute India into a ¹**[SOVEREIGN SOCIALIST SECULAR DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC]** and to secure to all its citizens :

JUSTICE, social, economic and political;

LIBERTY of thought, expression, belief, faith and worship;

EQUALITY of status and of opportunity;
and to promote among them all

FRATERNITY assuring the dignity of the individual and the ²[unity and integrity of the Nation];

IN OUR CONSTITUENT ASSEMBLY this twenty-sixth day of November, 1949 do **HEREBY ADOPT, ENACT AND GIVE TO OURSELVES THIS CONSTITUTION.**

1. Subs. by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec.2, for "Sovereign Democratic Republic" (w.e.f. 3.1.1977)
2. Subs. by the Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, Sec.2, for "Unity of the Nation" (w.e.f. 3.1.1977)

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CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

Part III (Articles 12 – 35)

(Subject to certain conditions, some exceptions
and reasonable restrictions)

guarantees these

Fundamental Rights

Right to Equality

- before law and equal protection of laws;
- irrespective of religion, race, caste, sex or place of birth;
- of opportunity in public employment;
- by abolition of untouchability and titles.

Right to Freedom

- of expression, assembly, association, movement, residence and profession;
- of certain protections in respect of conviction for offences;
- of protection of life and personal liberty;
- of free and compulsory education for children between the age of six and fourteen years;
- of protection against arrest and detention in certain cases.

Right against Exploitation

- for prohibition of traffic in human beings and forced labour;
- for prohibition of employment of children in hazardous jobs.

Right to Freedom of Religion

- freedom of conscience and free profession, practice and propagation of religion;
- freedom to manage religious affairs;
- freedom as to payment of taxes for promotion of any particular religion;
- freedom as to attendance at religious instruction or religious worship in certain educational institutions.

Cultural and Educational Rights

- for protection of interests of minorities;
- for minorities to establish and administer educational institutions;
- saving of certain Laws 31A–31D.

Right to Constitutional Remedies

- by issuance of directions or orders or writs by the Supreme Court and High Courts for enforcement of these Fundamental Rights.

